

Game Development 1 – Assignment 4:

Capstone Design Project Self-Evaluation Rubric

Assignment 4 – Grading Overview

Category	What is Evaluated
Core Mechanic – Clarity & Engagement	How clear, fun, and compelling the main gameplay mechanic is.
Core Mechanic – Balance & Challenge Progression	How well the gameplay is balanced and how difficulty ramps logically.
Design Improvements – Iteration & Refinement	Evidence of improving the game through iteration and playtesting.
Design Improvements – Reasoning & Justification	How well design decisions are explained and supported by course concepts.
Summary Document – Clarity & Structure	Organization and clarity of the 1-page summary; includes all required headings.
Rules/Controls Page	Clarity, completeness, and usability of rules or controls for playtesting.
Presentation & Polish – Visual/Audio Quality	Quality of visuals, audio, and overall polish in the game demo/prototype.
Presentation & Polish – Overall Usability	How intuitive and playable the game is; controls and instructions are easy to follow.

Use this rubric to assess your own work before submitting.

Score each criterion from 1–4 based on your project.

Criterion	4 – Excellent	3 – Good	2 – Satisfactory	1 – Needs Improvement	Your Score
Core Mechanic – Clarity & Engagement	The core mechanic is clear, engaging, and compelling	Core mechanic mostly clear; minor engagement issues	Core mechanic somewhat clear; engagement limited	Core mechanic unclear; not engaging	
Core Mechanic – Balance & Challenge Progression	Gameplay is well-balanced; difficulty curve is logical	Mostly balanced; minor difficulty inconsistencies	Some balance issues; difficulty progression inconsistent	Gameplay unbalanced; difficulty curve missing	
Design Improvements – Iteration & Refinement	Significant improvements made; clear evidence of playtesting and iteration	Some improvements; evidence of iteration present	Minor improvements; limited iteration	Few or no improvements ; no iteration	
Design Improvements – Reasoning & Justification	All design decisions explained using course concepts	Most decisions explained; some reasoning unclear	Some reasoning provided; partially unclear	Design decisions not explained	
Summary Document – Clarity & Structure	Clear, well-organized, communicates contributions; all headings included	Mostly clear; minor headings missing	Partially clear; some headings missing	Incomplete or disorganized	

Criterion	4 – Excellent	3 – Good	2 – Satisfactory	1 – Needs Improvement	Your Score
Rules/Controls Page	Clear, concise, complete; supports playtesting	Mostly clear; minor omissions	Partially clear; some key rules missing	Unclear or incomplete; difficult to play/test	
Presentation & Polish – Visual/Audio Quality	Game demo polished, visually/aurally coherent, playable	Mostly polished; minor inconsistencies	Playable but lacks polish; noticeable issues	Difficult to play, unfinished, lacks polish	
Presentation & Polish – Overall Usability	Gameplay clear and intuitive; controls/rules easy to understand	Mostly clear; minor usability issues	Some usability issues; controls/rules sometimes confusing	Gameplay unclear; controls/rules hard to use	

Instructions for Self-Grading:

1. Score each criterion honestly from 1–4.
2. Maximum total score = 32 points.
3. Multiply your total by 3.125 to convert to a percentage out of 100.
4. Use this reflection to check that your submission clearly communicates your contributions and meets the expectations for a portfolio-ready project.
5. Instructor reserves the right to overrule your self-graded marks if deemed appropriate.